

GRAPES

There are two different types of grapes—black and white. But black grapes are really dark red, and white grapes are light green. Grapes are delicious to eat fresh, and keep their sweetness when dried, too. But most of the grapes grown in the world are used for making wine. Grape plants are called vines, and they are planted in rows in vineyards. Vines need a lot of care, and it takes lots of hard work and skill to produce a bottle of fine wine.

Pruning

As vines grow, they are often cut back so they have a few strong branches rather than lots of weaker ones. This work is called pruning and must be done by hand.



Bitter wine

Red and white wine can also be made into vinegar. It is produced when special vinegar yeasts ferment the wine and turn it sour. Vinegars can be made from other liquids, like cider or malt, and are used as a flavoring. They can also be mixed with foods to pickle and preserve them.



Grapes need rain to swell them and sun to ripen them.



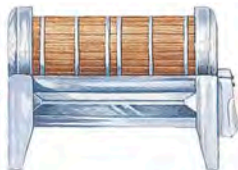
Broad vine leaves shade the grapes from the direct glare of the sun and the battering rain.

From grapes to wine

First the grapes are crushed and pressed to mix the yeast with the sugar in the grapes. This is called fermentation. Then the juice is filtered and poured into vats. These are left in a cool place for the flavor of the wine to develop.



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Press